

Friendzy (www.friendzy.com)

Friendzy is a free social networking site used mainly for making connections based on relationships of a sociable nature. It makes use of polls and a “friendzine” for people online, and aims to bring those people with different views and opinions together. This is a good way of introducing people to one another, and so too, is the use of a number of icons called “friendzicons” that members can send to one another. Friendzy has led to a growth of online social network communities that are built up through online trusted connections. The site also lists a classifieds section that can be posted to by members of the Friendzy community. Friendzy helps to maintain connections and to build new ones socially between its members.

LinkedIn (www.linkedin.com)

LinkedIn, founded in May 2003, focuses on professional users creating networks of co-workers and other business associates. LinkedIn allows members to look for jobs, seeking out experts in a particular area, or to make contact with other professionals through a chain of trusted connections. LinkedIn has a very clean and professional design, and is probably the site with the least (if any) potential for social purposes.

Meetup (www.meetup.com)

Meetup, set up in 2002, is a networking site almost entirely devoted to the arranging of meetings for communities with like-minded interests. Unlike most other SNSs, where the focus is towards user profiles and their networks of personal friends or associates, Meetup organizes local interest groups that meet monthly at local cafes and establishments. Meetup earns money from establishments that pay to be listed as possible venues for these meetings, and also from services such as text advertising and its advanced MeetupPlus functionality.

orkut (www.orkut.com)

orkut, a newcomer to the social networking scene, has attracted a lot of attention because of its links with Google, for whom the site developer works for. Primarily a social site, orkut has a relatively